Getting started with Depot

A guide for everyday use

Edition 2026.11

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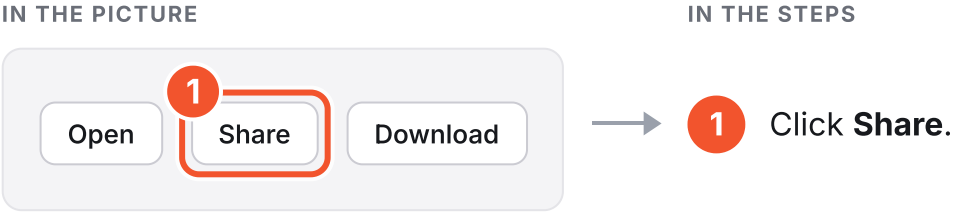
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How to use this guide

- Each chapter shows one everyday task. Most sections have a picture of the screen and numbered steps below it.

1 The orange numbered badges in a picture match the numbered steps. Badge 1 shows where to click for step 1.



- Words in **bold** are labels you see on the screen, such as **Share** or **Upload**.

Depot has a light look and a dark look. The pictures switch between the two from chapter to chapter, so you will recognise both. Chapter 12, “Light or dark: making Depot comfortable”, shows how to choose.

- Part 1 covers the everyday basics. Part 2 covers things you will need less often.

- Whenever you need a chapter fast, turn back to the contents page.

PART 1

Quick start

1 Signing in

2 Finding your way around

3 Adding files and folders

4 Opening, previewing and editing

5 Keeping things organised

6 Sharing a file

7 Sharing a folder

8 Keeping track of what you've shared

9 Getting notified about files and folders

10 Searching and asking questions

11 Favorites and files shared with you

12 Light or dark: making Depot comfortable

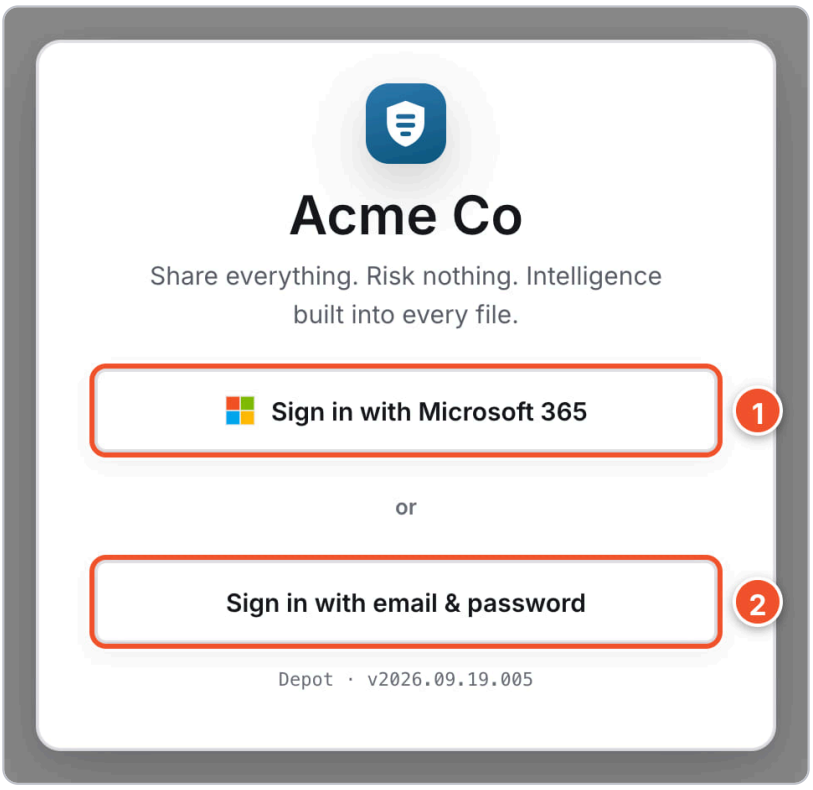
13 What the people you share with see

CHAPTER 1

Signing in

Depot is where your team keeps and shares files. After you sign in, it opens Home, or the file or folder a share email linked to.

The sign-in card



1. Click **Sign in with Microsoft 365** if your company has turned it on.
2. Otherwise, click **Sign in with email & password**, then type your email and password on the page that opens. If you forget your password, ask your administrator.

> **Tip**
> To sign out, click your name in the top right corner, then click **Sign out**.

CHAPTER 2

Finding your way around

Every page in Depot has the same top bar and left rail. Home sums up what is happening in your workspace.

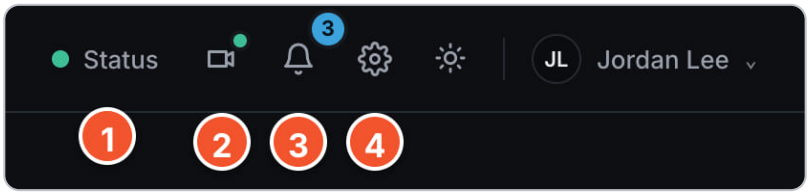
The top bar

The search box sits at the left of the top bar.



1. Click the search box to find files. See “Searching and asking questions”.

The right side of the top bar



1. Click **Status** to check that Depot is running normally.
2. Click the Meetings icon, a video camera, to see who is online and call them.
3. Click the bell to see your **Notifications**.
4. Click the gear to open **Settings**, for your profile, appearance and notifications.

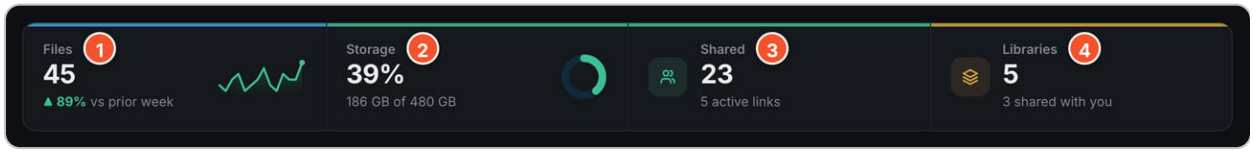
- Click the sun or moon icon to switch between light and dark. See “Light or dark: making Depot comfortable”.
- Click your name, for example **Jordan Lee**, to open a menu with **Sign out**.

The left rail

- **Home**, **Files**, **Favorites**, **Shared with me**, **Links** and **Trash** open those pages.
- **Files** shows the library you have open. A library is a set of files and folders, like a shared drive.
- Click the library name at the top of the rail to switch libraries. In that list, click the star next to a library to pin it: pinned libraries stay listed under the library name, one click away.
- Drag the grip on the rail's right edge to make the rail wider or narrower.
- **Quick access**, further down, lists files you opened recently, newest first.

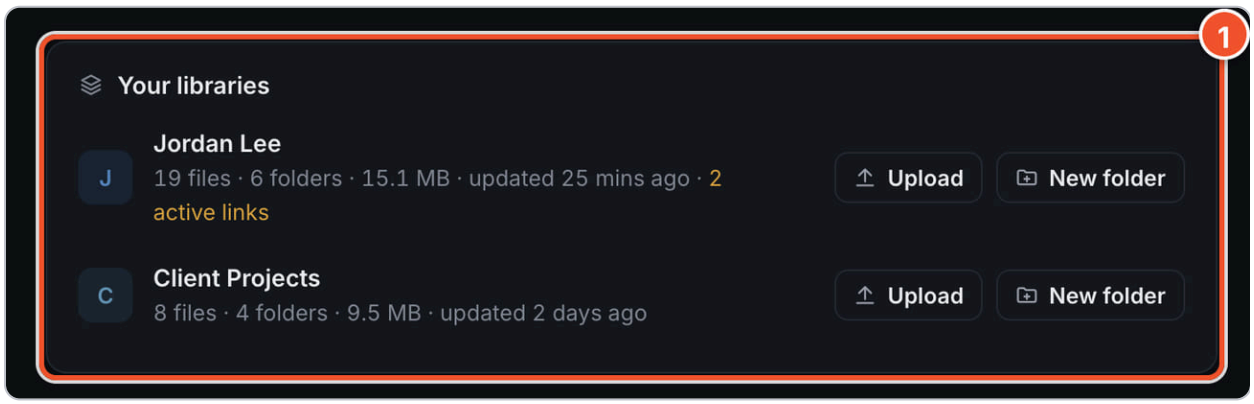
Home

Home opens when you sign in. Click **Home** in the left rail to come back to it.



1. **Files** shows how many files you have, and how that is changing.
2. **Storage** shows how much space you are using.
3. **Shared** counts files others added, and your live links.
4. **Libraries** shows how many libraries you can open.

Your libraries



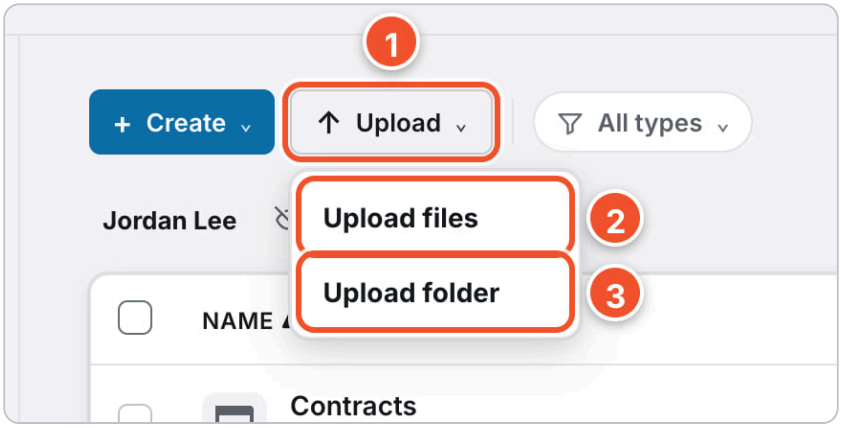
1 **Your libraries** lists your own libraries, with **Upload** and **New folder** buttons. **Shared with you** and **Recent files** sit below it.

CHAPTER 3

Adding files and folders

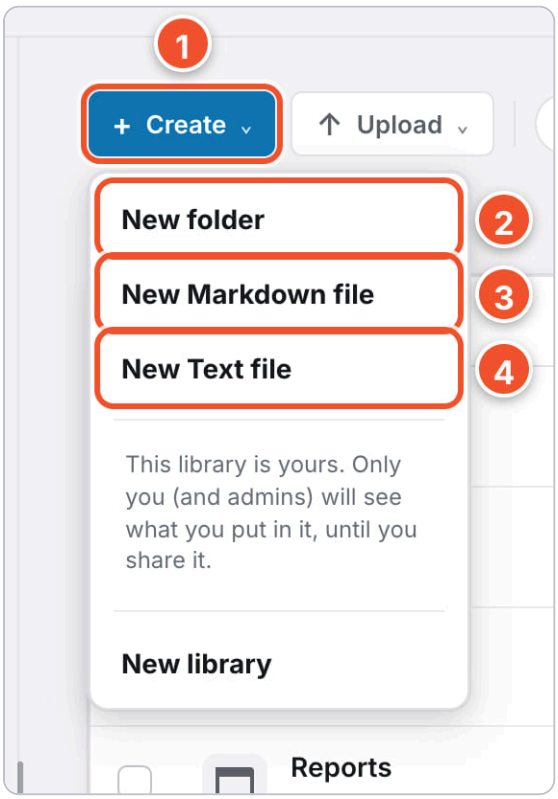
Upload files from your computer, or drag them onto the file list. New files land in the folder you have open.

Upload files or a folder



1. Click **Upload** above your files.
2. Choose **Upload files** to add one or more files.
3. Choose **Upload folder** to add a whole folder, with everything inside it.

Create a new file or folder



1. Click **Create** above your files.
2. Choose **New folder** to make a folder.
3. Choose **New Markdown file** for notes with headings and lists.
4. Choose **New Text file** for plain text.

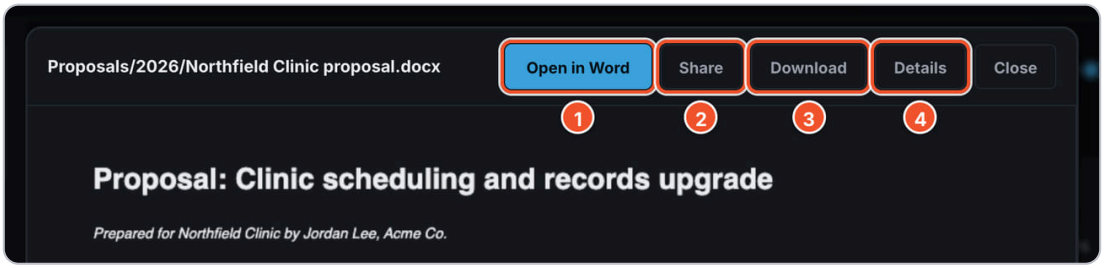
> **Tip**
> Type a name and click **OK**. A new file opens straight away, ready to type into.

> **Note**
> If your company has turned on editing in the browser, the menu also offers **New Word document** and **New Excel spreadsheet**. In a library shared with you as read-only, **Upload** is hidden and **Create** offers only **New library**. Ask the owner for Read-Write access.

CHAPTER 4

Opening, previewing and editing

Click a file's name to look inside it without downloading it. A row of buttons sits above the preview.



1. Click **Open in Word** to open a Word file in Word on your computer and make your changes there. Excel and PowerPoint files get a matching button.
2. Click **Share** to send the file to someone.
3. Click **Download** to save a copy to your computer.
4. Click **Details** to see who added it, when it changed and where it is kept.

> **Note**
>
> If your company has turned on editing in the browser, the first button is **Edit** instead, and an **Open in** ⌄ button beside it offers both ways of opening the file.

What you can preview

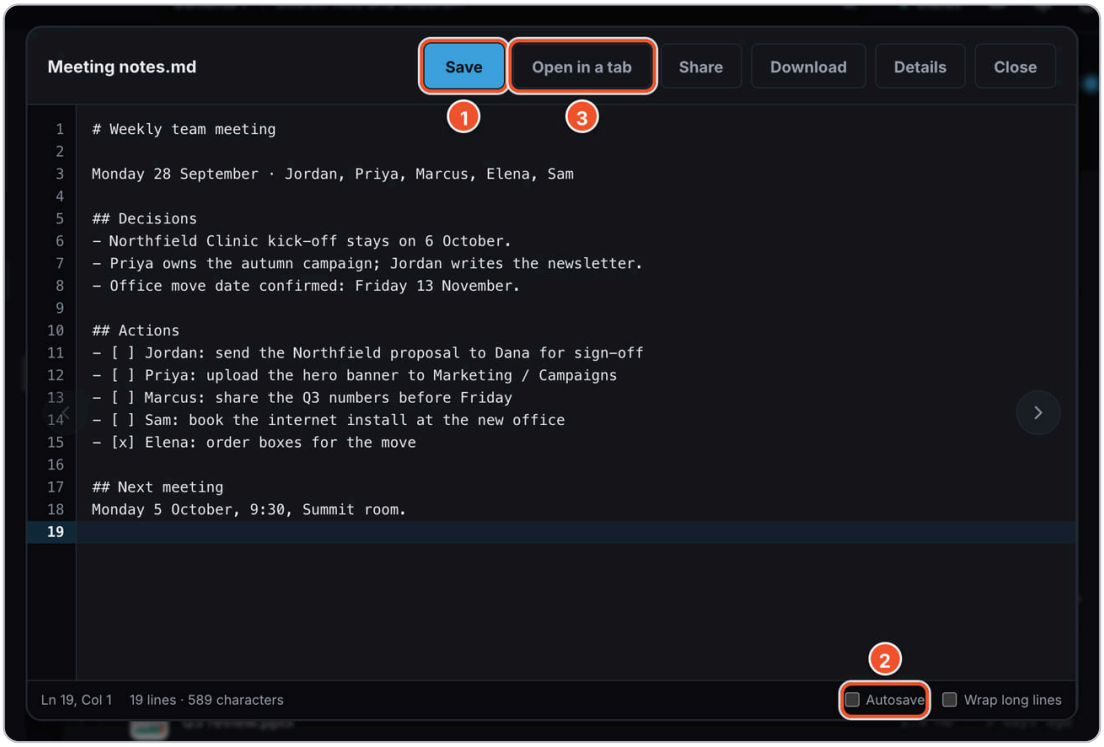
These files open right inside Depot, without downloading them:

- Pictures, PDFs, videos, audio and saved emails.
- Word documents and Excel spreadsheets.
- Text, Markdown, CSV, JSON and log files, shown with line numbers.

> **Tip**
>
> Click the arrows at the sides of the preview, or press the left or right arrow key, to see the previous or next file.

Text files: type straight into them

Text, Markdown, CSV, JSON and other plain-text files open in Depot's own editor, with line numbers. You can change them right there.



1. Type your changes into the file. Click **Save**, or press ⌘S (Ctrl+S on Windows), to save them straight away.
2. **Autosave** is off unless you tick it. Nothing is written until you press **Save** (Ctrl+S, or Cmd+S on a Mac), so closing a file without saving is the way back from a slip, and Depot asks before it closes a file that has unsaved changes. Tick **Autosave** if you would rather have Depot save for you a few seconds after you stop typing, and again when you close the file or switch to another tab.
3. Click **Open in a tab** to give the file a browser tab of its own.

> **Note**
>
> A new text file (**+ Create**, then **New Markdown file** or **New Text file**) opens in a tab of its own straight away. You can also hold ⌘ (Ctrl on Windows) while you click a text file in the list, or click it with the middle mouse button.

A file in a tab of its own

The tab is named after the file, so you can keep several open while you work in Depot and come back to them like any other browser tab. Everything works the same there: **Save**, **Autosave** and the line numbers. The folder name under the file's name opens that folder in Depot.



> **Note**
>
> If someone else saved the same file while you were typing, Depot will not save over their work. The bar at the bottom says the file changed elsewhere, and you choose **Use theirs** or **Keep mine**.

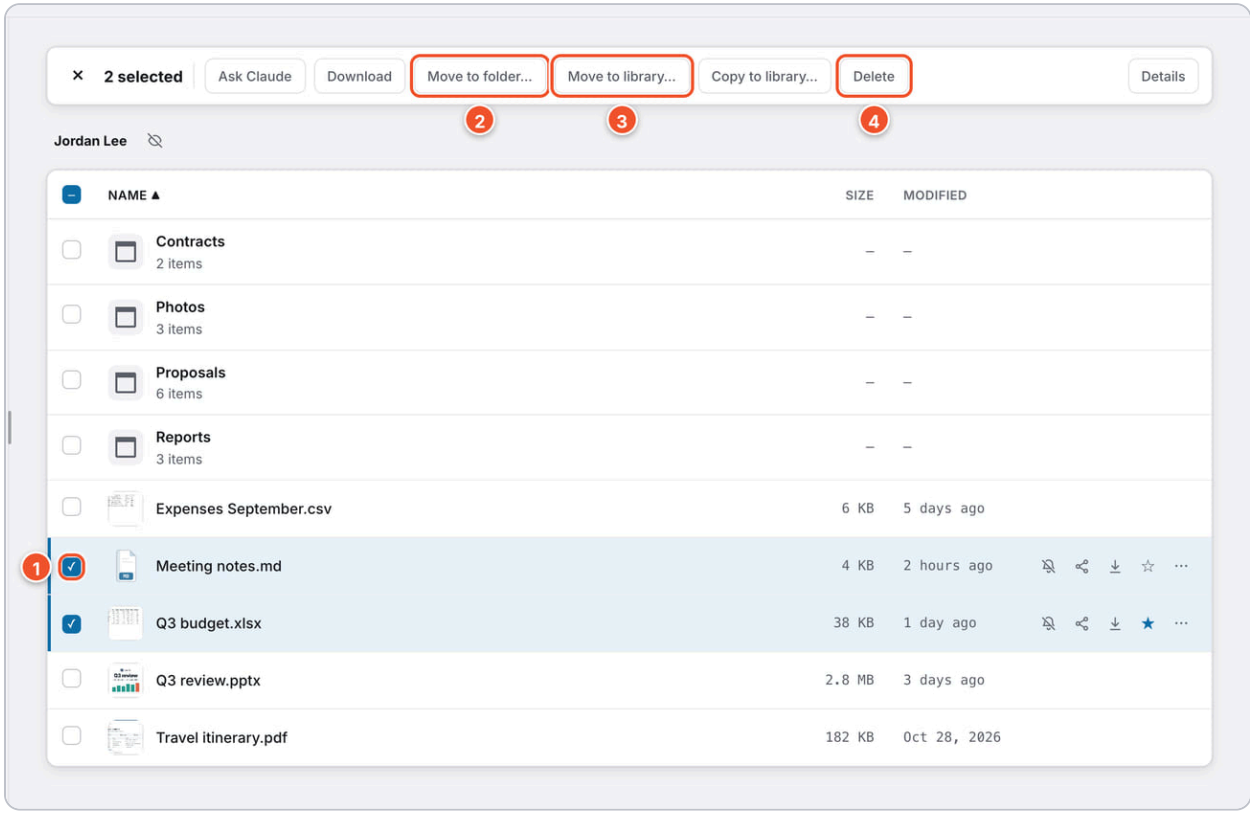
CHAPTER 5

Keeping things organised

Folders, filters and Trash keep your files easy to find. To add a folder, see “Adding files and folders”.

Work on several items at once

Select files and folders, and the selection bar appears above the list.



1. Click the checkbox at the start of each row you want.
2. Click **Move to folder...**, then click a folder to move everything into it.
3. Click **Move to library...** to move everything you selected to another library.
4. Click **Delete** to move everything you selected to Trash.

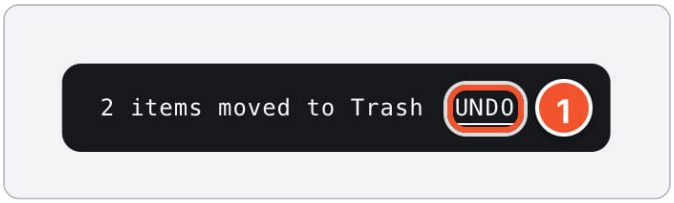
Rename or move one item

1. Click the three dots at the end of the row.
2. Click **Rename...**, type the new name and click **OK**.

- The same menu has **Move to folder...**, and you can also drag a row onto a folder in the list.
- Renaming a folder does not change who it is shared with.

Delete, undo and restore

Deleted files go to Trash, so you can get them back.



1. Click **Undo** if you change your mind. It stays until you close it or Depot shows another message.

- Later, click **Trash** in the left rail. The page is called **Recycle bin**.
- Click **Restore** next to the file you want back.

> **Note**
> Deleting a folder asks you to confirm first, because it can end sharing on that folder.

Filter, sort and change the view

- Click **All types** and choose a type, such as **Images**, to show only those files, or **Folders** to show only the folders here.
- Click **Name**, **Size** or **Modified** at the top of the list to sort by it. Click again to reverse it.
- Drag the slider next to **Details** to the right for tiles, or to the left for a list.

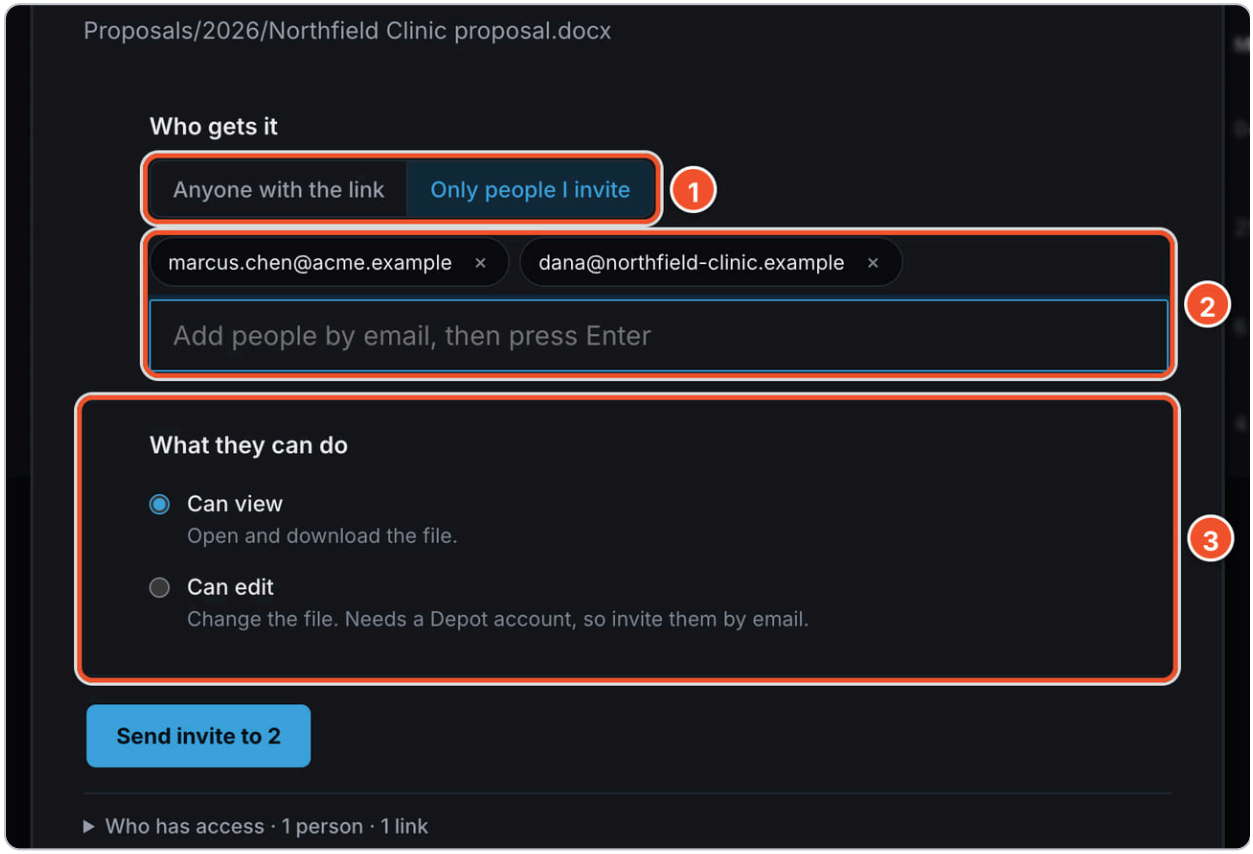
CHAPTER 6

Sharing a file

Share turns a file into a link, or an invite to the people you name. You choose who gets it, what they can do and how long it lasts.

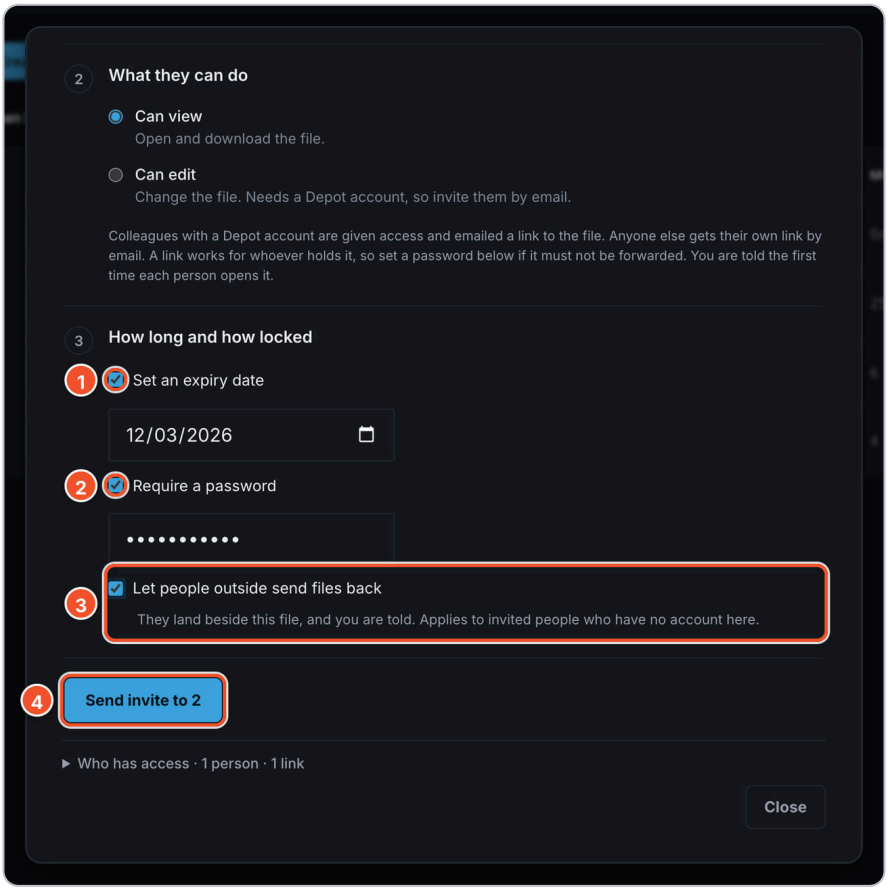
Choose who gets it and what they can do

Click **Share** on a file's row, or in the bar above its preview.



1. Under **Who gets it**, choose **Anyone with the link** or **Only people I invite**.
2. If you invite people, type each email address and press Enter.
3. Under **What they can do**, choose **Can view** or **Can edit**. **Can edit** is for people you invite.

Set how long it lasts and how locked it is



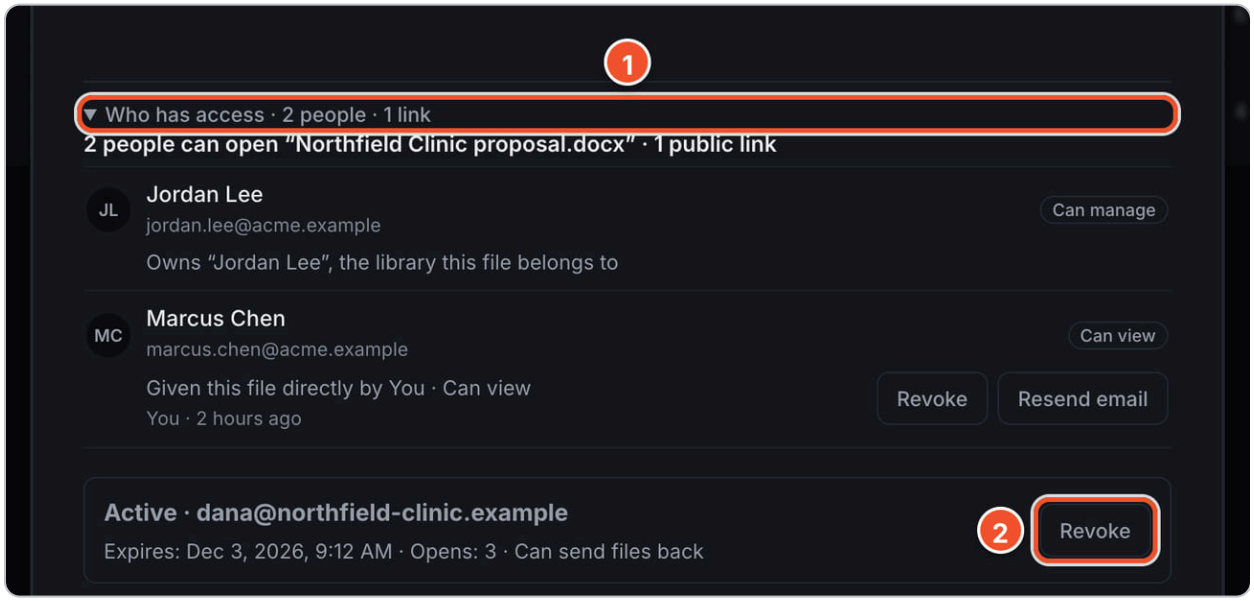
1. Turn on **Set an expiry date** to choose when it stops working.
2. Turn on **Require a password** so only people who know it can open the file.
3. Turn on **Let people outside send files back** if you want the people you invited to send files to you.
4. Click **Create link** to copy a link, or **Send invite** to email the people you added.

> **Note**
>
> A link with no expiry date never expires. An invite with no expiry date expires after 30 days.

What the people you invite receive

- A colleague with a Depot account gets an email with a link. If you can give them access, the file also appears in their **Shared with me**. If not, the link opens a view-only copy, only for them, once they sign in.
- Anyone else, such as people outside Acme, gets a link of their own by email. If the email cannot be sent, Depot shows you the link to pass on.
- A password only protects links for people outside Acme. Colleagues sign in instead. To see the page people outside Acme open, turn to “What the people you share with see”.
- If you can only view a file yourself, you cannot create a link to it or let others edit it.

See who has access, and revoke it



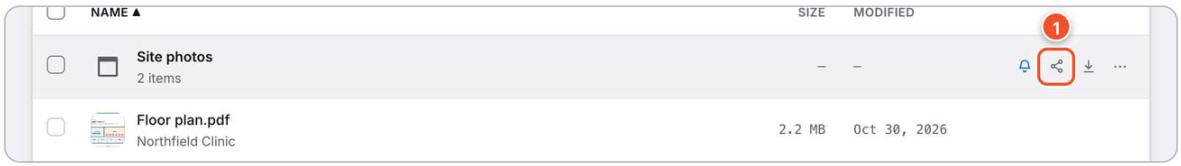
1. Click **Who has access** to see everyone who can open the file, and any links you have made.
2. Click **Revoke** next to a person or a link to take away their access.

CHAPTER 7

Sharing a folder

Share a folder when someone needs more than one file. Create a link anyone can open, or send it to named people.

Open the folder's Share window



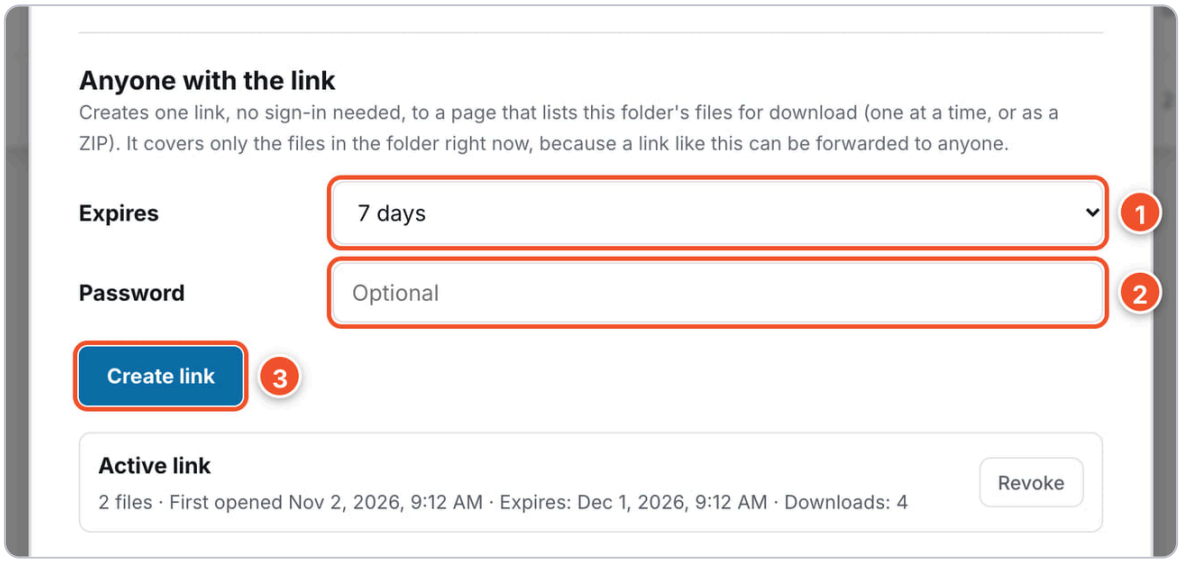
1. Point to the folder, then click the **Share** icon on its row.

> **Tip**
> You can also click the folder's checkbox, then click **Share** in the selection bar.

> **Note**
> If you own or manage the library, the window also has **People and groups** at the top. It works the same way as in “Sharing a whole library”.

Create a link anyone can open

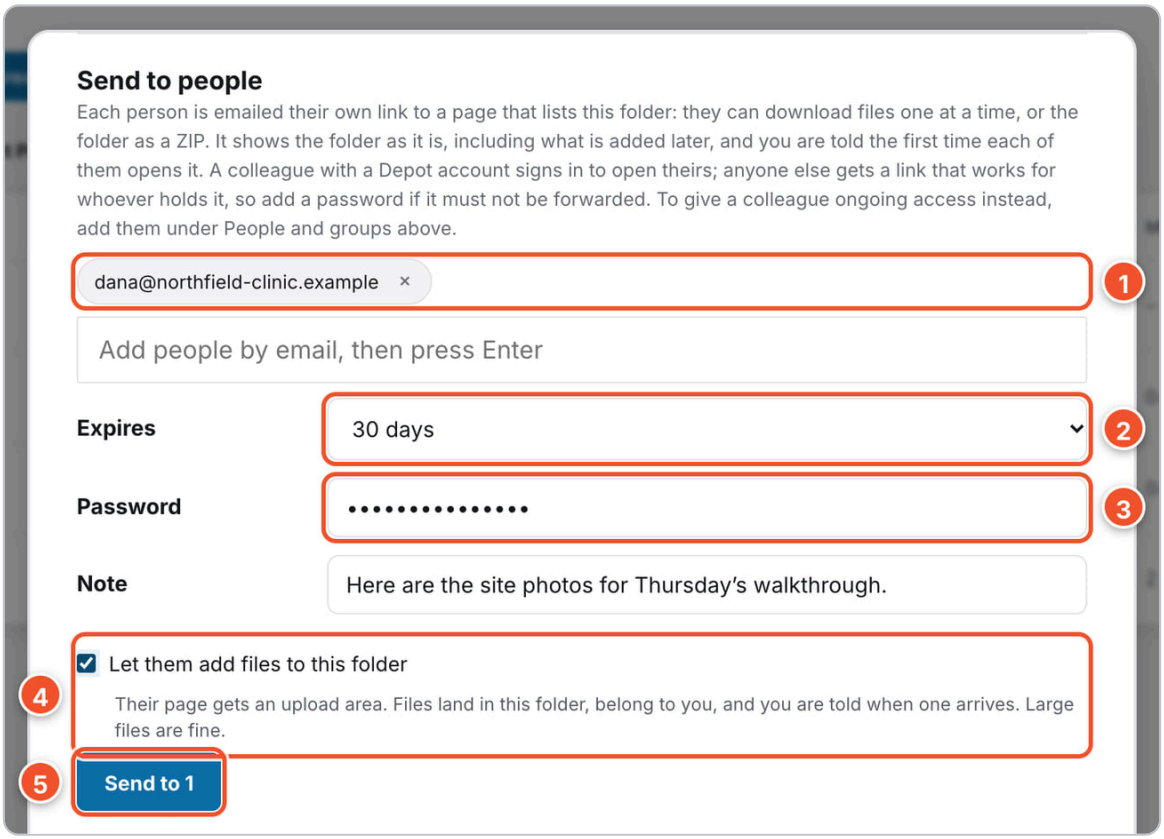
Use **Anyone with the link** for one link to hand around. It only shows the files in the folder right now, not ones you add later.



1. Under **Anyone with the link**, choose how long it lasts under **Expires**.
2. Add a **Password** if you want one.
3. Click **Create link**. Depot copies the link so you can paste it anywhere.

Send it to named people

Use **Send to people** when you know who needs the folder. They always see its newest files, including ones you add later.



1. Under **Send to people**, type each email address and press Enter.
2. Under **Expires**, choose how long the link should work.
3. Add a **Password** if the files are sensitive, and a **Note** to say why you sent them.
4. Turn on **Let them add files to this folder** if they should send files back.
5. Click **Send to 1**. The number is how many people you added.

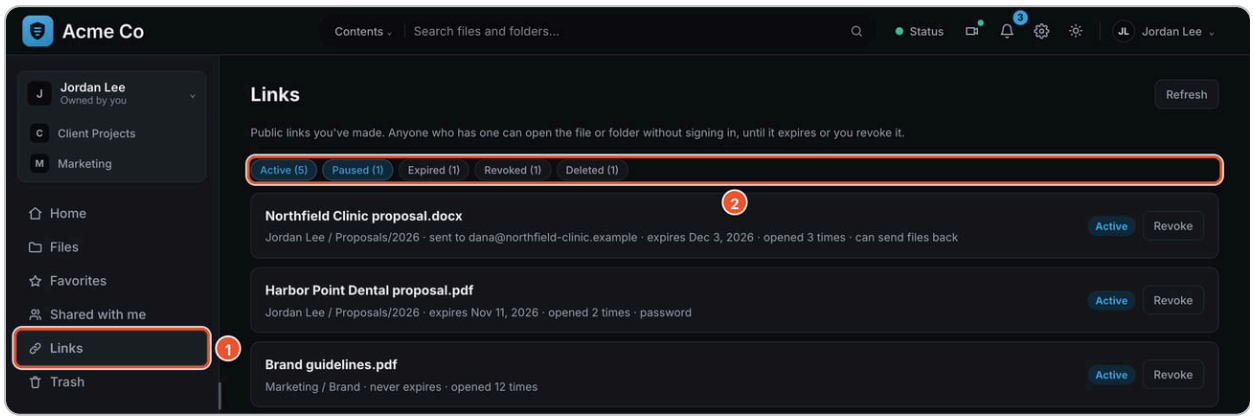
> **Note**
>
> Colleagues sign in to open the folder. Anyone else can open the link without signing in, so add a password if it must not be passed on. To stop any folder link working, click **Revoke** next to it in this window.

CHAPTER 8

Keeping track of what you've shared

Links keeps a record of every link you have made, from any file or folder, whether it still works or not.

See your links

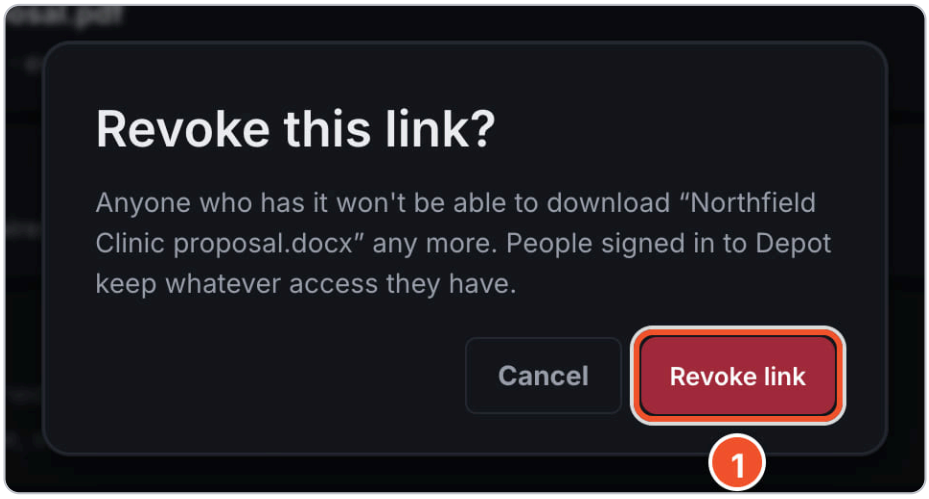


1. Click **Links** in the left rail.
2. Click the chips above the list to show or hide links by status.

- **Active** links work right now.
- **Paused** links will not open, because you lost the right to edit the file or folder. The card explains why.
- **Expired** links have passed their expiry date.
- **Revoked** links are ones you turned off.
- **Deleted** links point to a file or folder that no longer exists.

> **Tip**
> Each card shows who the link was sent to and when it expires. It also shows how often it was opened, and whether it needs a password.

Revoke a link



1. Click **Revoke** on the link's card, then click **Revoke link** to confirm.

> **Note**
> Nobody can use the link after that. Colleagues who already had access in Depot keep it.

Keep an eye on links from Home

- The **Links you sent** card on Home lists your newest links, and whether each has been opened.
- A bar above your libraries on Home warns you when a link expires within a week.

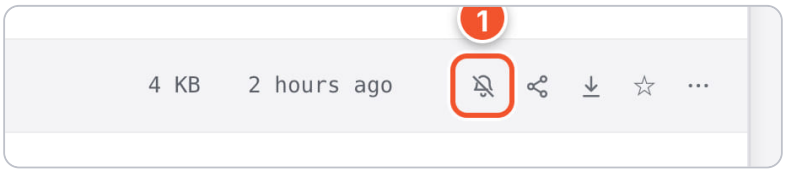
CHAPTER 9

Getting notified about files and folders

Depot tells you when the files and folders you care about change. You choose what it tells you about.

Follow a file

Every file has its own bell. Point to a file's row to show it.

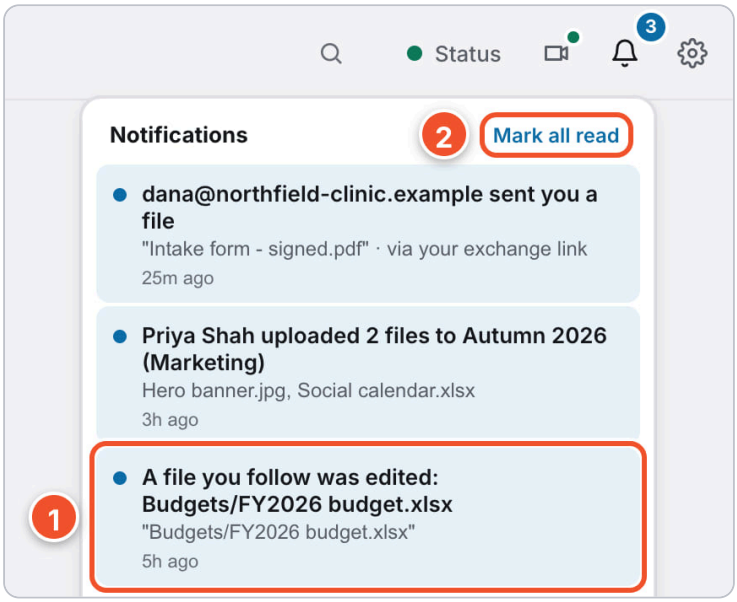


1. Click the bell icon, **Follow this file for updates**. The bell loses its slash and turns blue.

> **Tip**
> Depot now tells you when someone downloads the file from a link. If your company has turned on editing in the browser, it also tells you when someone edits it.

See everything in the bell

Click the bell in the top bar to open **Notifications**. The newest notices are at the top.

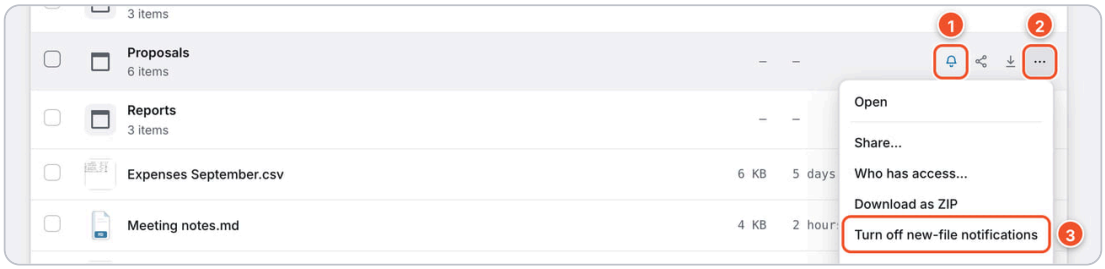


1. Click a notice to jump straight to the file or folder.
2. Click **Mark all read** to clear every unread dot.

- Notices tell you when someone opens or downloads something you shared, or sends files back to you.
- They also tell you when you are given access to something.

Hear about new files in a folder

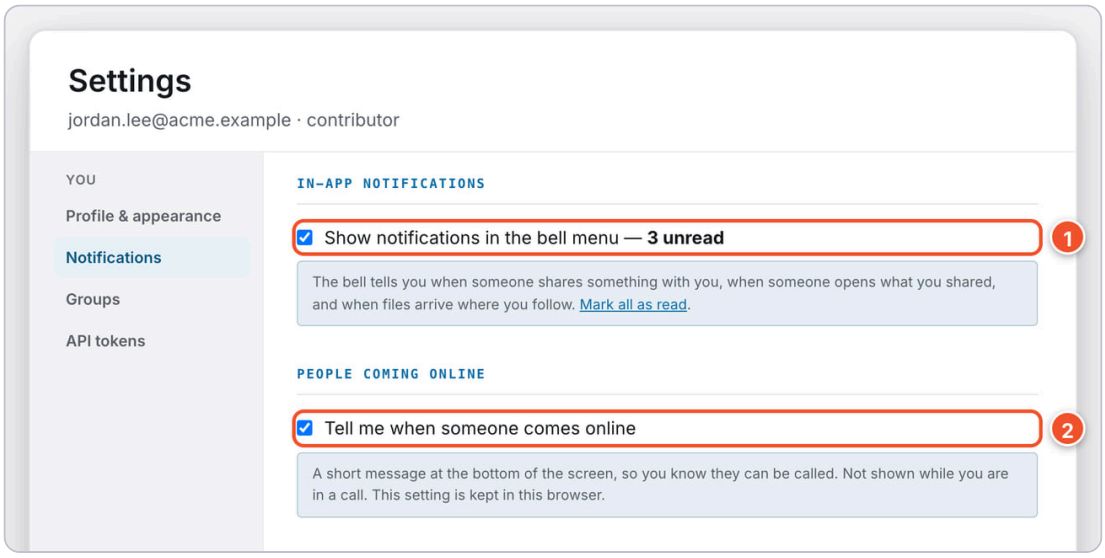
Folders you own already tell you when a new file lands in them. You do not need to turn this on.



1. Point to one of your folders. Its bell icon is already blue, with no slash through it.
2. Click the three dots at the end of the folder's row.
3. Click **Turn off new-file notifications** to stop. Anyone the folder is shared with can do the same for themselves.

Choose what the bell does

Click the gear in the top bar, then click **Notifications**.

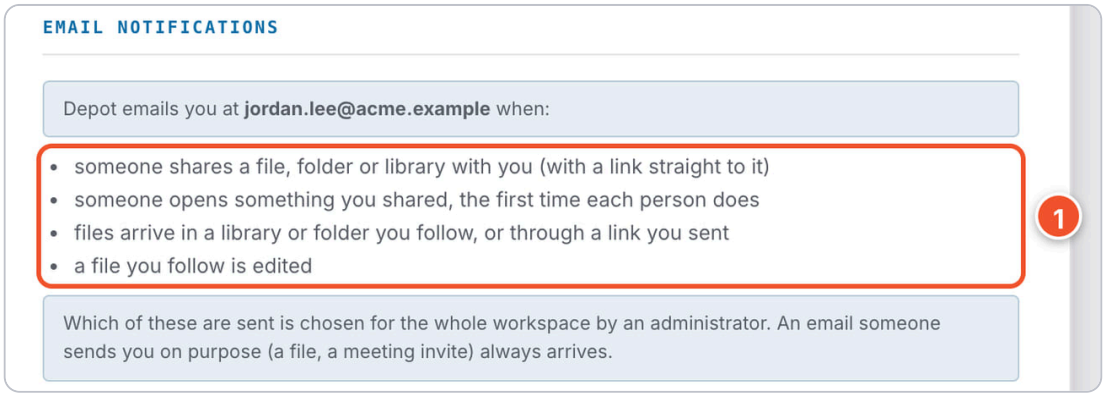


1. Turn off **Show notifications in the bell menu** to stop notices in the bell.
2. Turn off **Tell me when someone comes online** to stop those messages.

Get notices by email

Depot can also email you, so you hear about things even when Depot is not open. The email has a link straight to the file or folder.

To see which notices you get by email, click the gear in the top bar, then **Notifications**. Look under **Email notifications**.



1 This list shows every notice Depot emails to you, and the address it uses.

- Someone shares a file, folder or library with you.
- Someone opens something you shared, the first time each person does.
- Files arrive in a library or folder you follow, or through a link you sent.
- A file you follow is edited in the browser, if your company has turned that on.

> **Note**
> Your administrator chooses which emails everyone at your company gets. If the page says email isn't set up yet, ask your administrator to turn it on.

CHAPTER 10

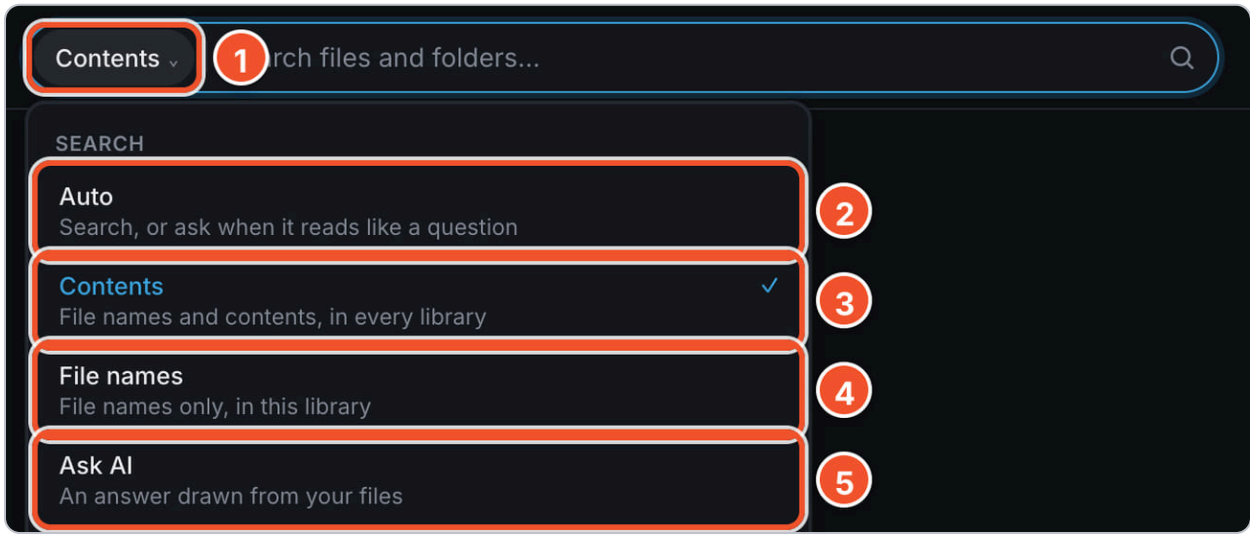
Searching and asking questions

The search box in the top bar finds files by name or by what is inside them. If your company has turned on AI, you can also ask questions.

Search for a file

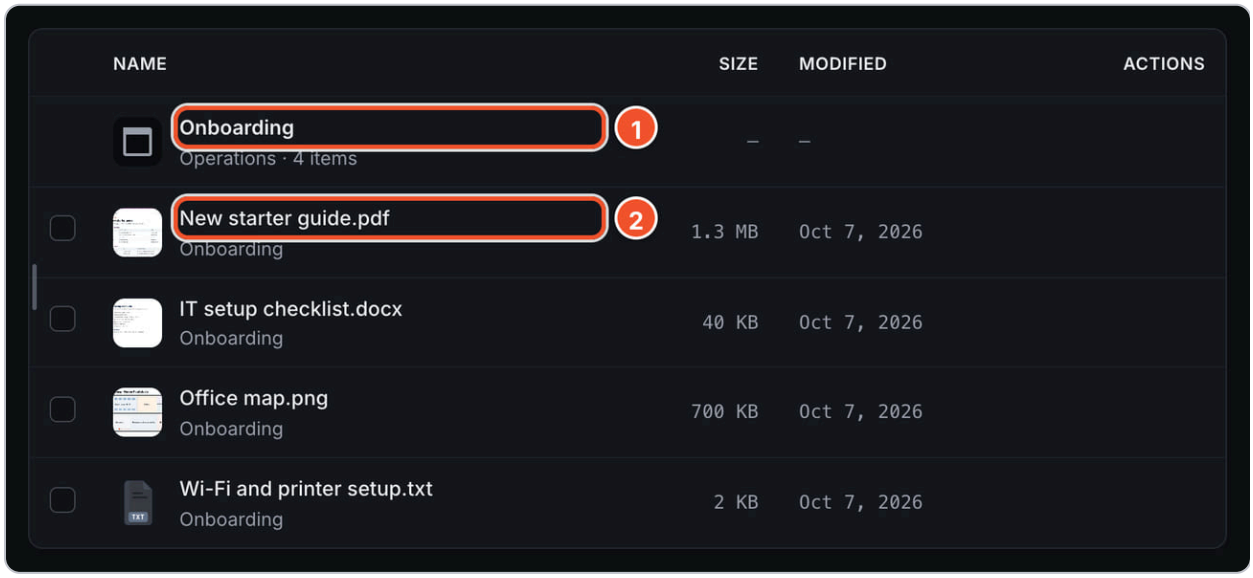
Click the search box, type a word or a file name, and press Enter. Depot looks through every library you can open, and finds a word even when it is only inside a file.

Choose what you search



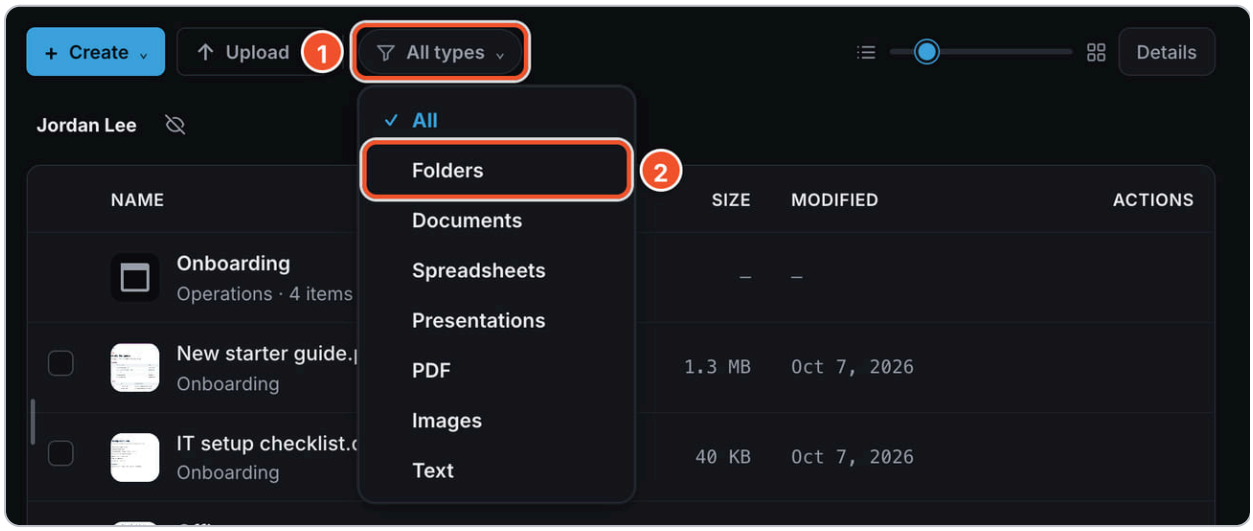
1. Click the button next to the search box. It starts with **Contents**.
2. Choose **Auto** to search, or to get an answer whenever what you type reads like a question.
3. Choose **Contents** to search file names and what is inside files, in every library you can open.
4. Choose **File names** to match file names only, in the library you are in.
5. Choose **Ask AI** to treat everything you type as a question.

What the results show



1. Folders whose name matches come first. Under each one is the library and folder it lives in. Click it to open the folder.
2. Files come next, each with its folder under the name. Click one to open it.

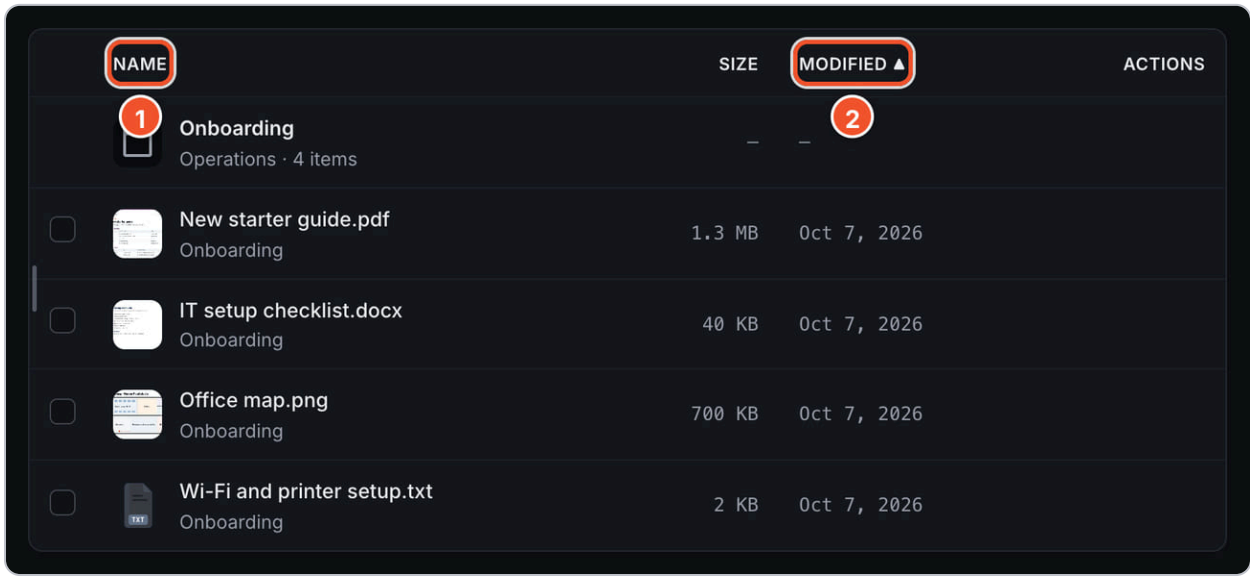
Narrow the results by type



1. Click **All types** above the list.
2. Choose **Folders** to see only the folders that matched, or a kind of file such as **Documents** or **PDF**. Choose **All** to see everything again.

> **Note**
> The same menu works while you are browsing a folder: **Folders** shows only its subfolders, **Documents** only the Word files, and so on.

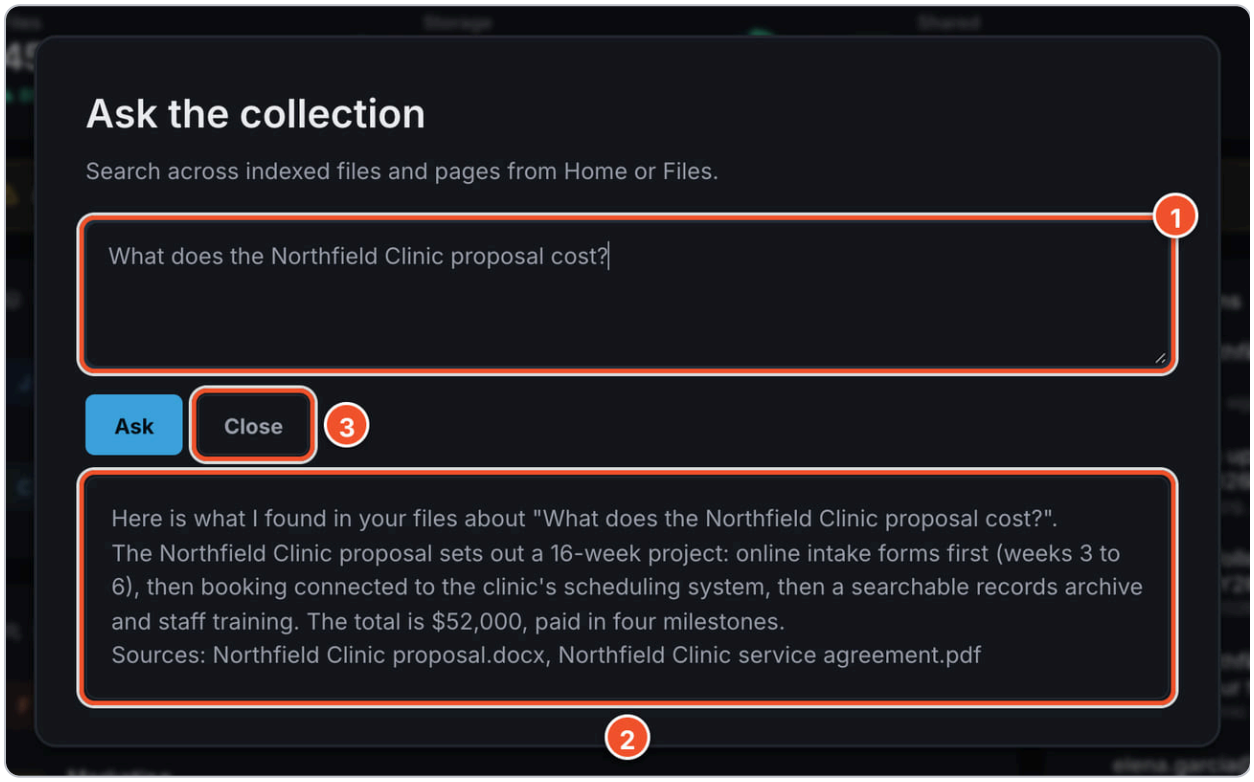
Sort the results



1. Results start with the best match first.
2. Click **Name**, **Size** or **Modified** to sort by it. Click again to sort the other way, and a third time to go back to best match first. Depot remembers your choice for your next search.

Ask a question

Click the button next to the search box and choose **Ask AI**. Type a full question and press Enter. For example: What does the Northfield Clinic proposal cost? A window called **Ask the collection** opens.



1. Your question appears at the top.
2. The answer appears underneath. It only uses files you are allowed to open.
3. Click **Close** when you are done.

Ask about particular files

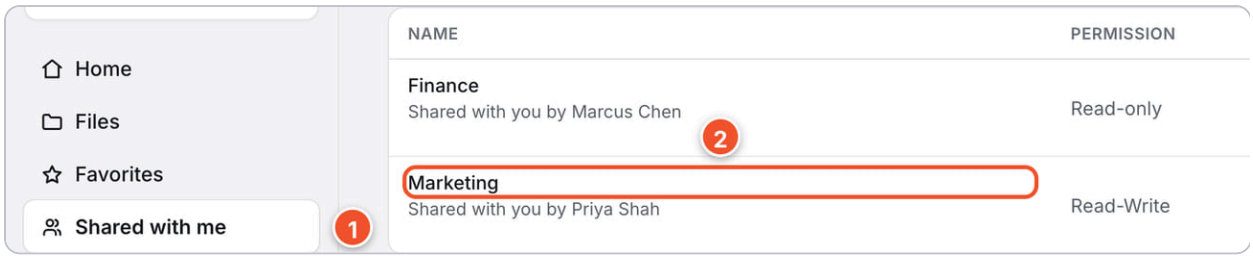
1. Select the files you want to ask about.
2. Click the **Ask Claude** button in the selection bar. You can also right-click a file and choose **Ask AI about this**.
3. Type your question, then click **Ask Claude**. The answer only uses the files you chose.

CHAPTER 11

Favorites and files shared with you

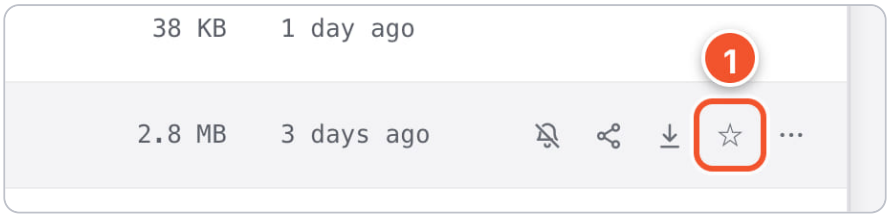
Star the files you use most. Find what other people have shared with you.

See what other people have shared with you



1. Click **Shared with me** in the left rail.
2. Click any row to open it where it lives. The **Permission** column shows what you can do there.

Star a file



1. Point to a file and click the star on its row. The star turns solid.

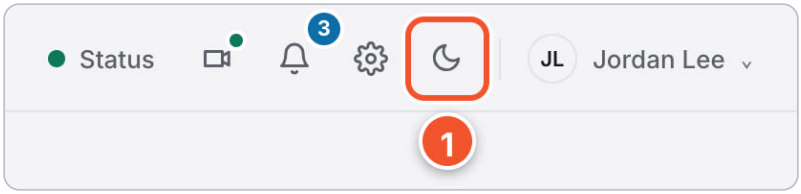
- Click **Favorites** in the left rail to see your starred files in this library.

CHAPTER 12

Light or dark: making Depot comfortable

Click the sun or moon icon in the top bar to switch light and dark.

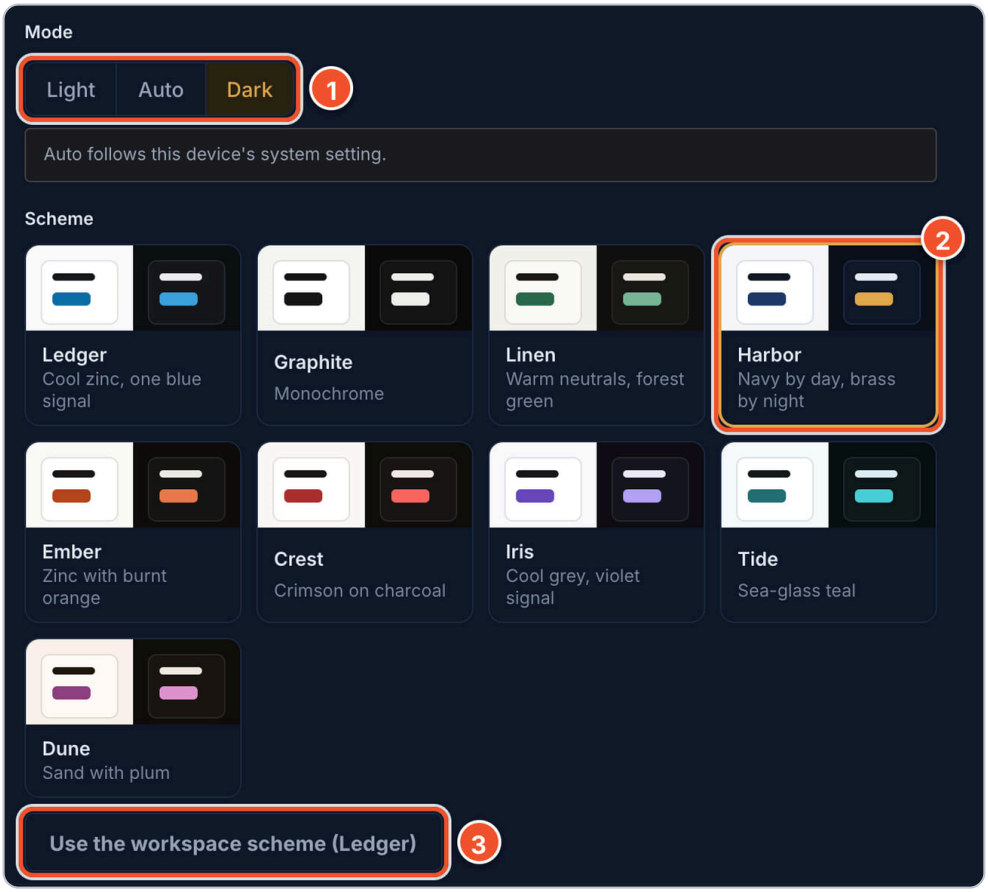
The quick way



1. Click the sun or moon icon at the right of the top bar. Depot switches right away.

More choices in Settings

Click the gear in the top bar. **Settings** opens on **Profile & appearance**.



1. Under **Mode**, click **Light**, **Auto** or **Dark**. **Auto** follows your computer.
2. Click a colour card under **Scheme** to use it on this device.
3. Click **Use the workspace scheme** to go back to your company's colours.

> **Tip**
> On the same page, click **Upload photo** to add your picture, type your name in **Full name**, then click **Save profile**.

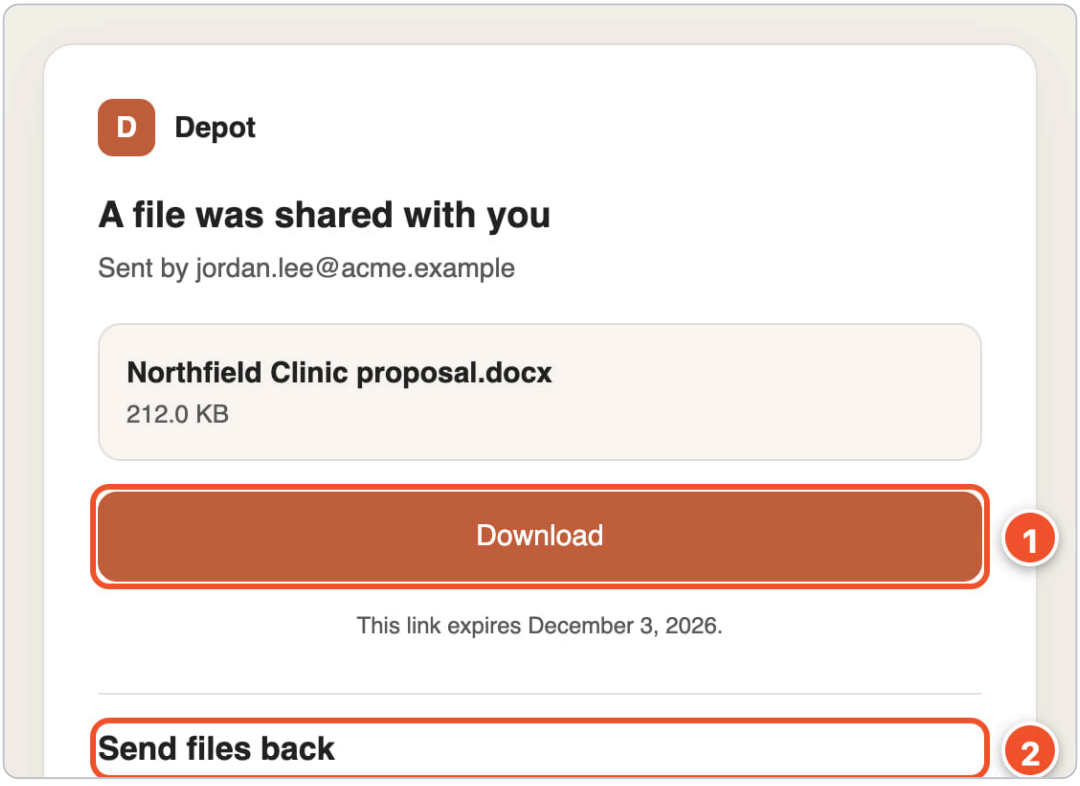
CHAPTER 13

What the people you share with see

People outside Acme do not sign in to Depot. Your link opens a plain page with only what you sent them. You can pass these steps on if they need help.

A shared file

The page shows the file's name and size, who sent it and when the link stops working.

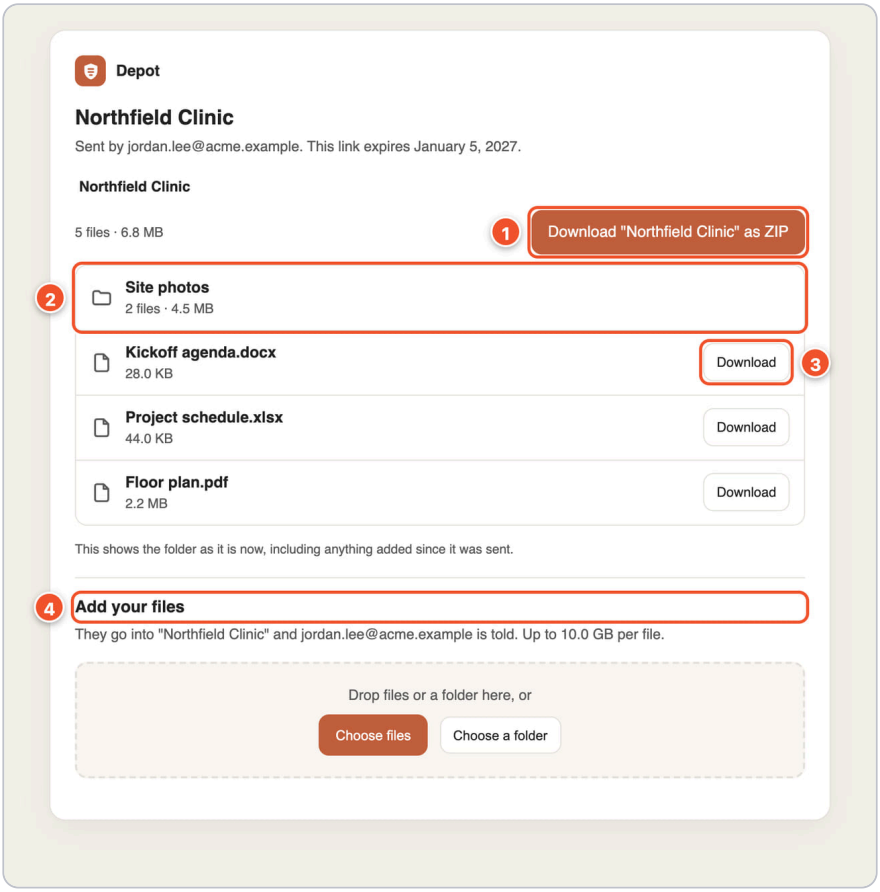


1. They click **Download** to save the file.
2. If you let them send files back, they use **Send files back** to send files to you.

> **Note**
>
> If you set a password, the page asks for it first. They type it in the **Password** box and click **Unlock**. Give them the password another way, such as by phone.

A shared folder

A folder page lets them look inside first. Subfolders show up in the list, alongside the files.



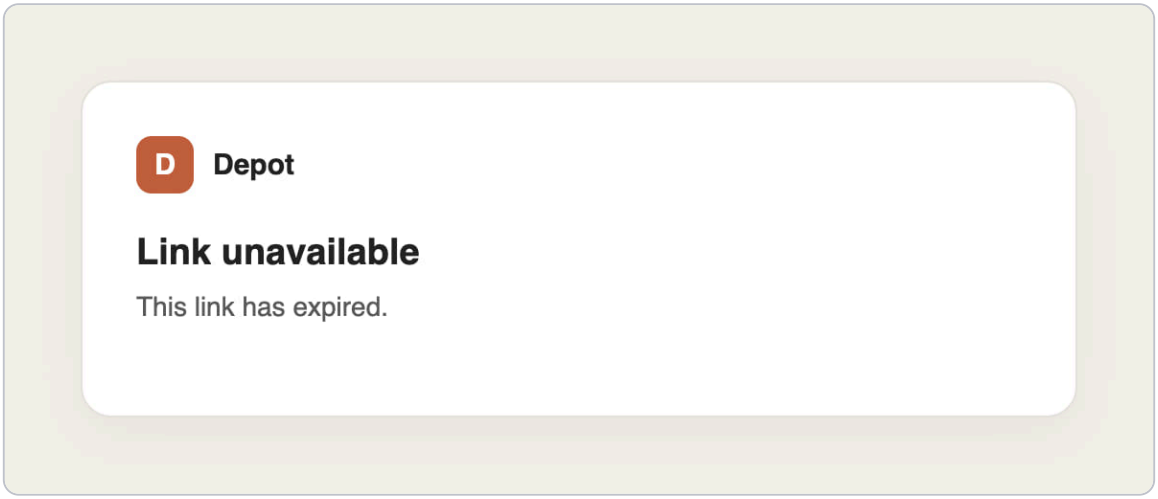
1. They click **Download "Northfield Clinic" as ZIP** to get every file at once.
2. They click a folder in the list to open it.
3. They click **Download** next to a file to get only that one.
4. If you let them add files, they use **Add your files** to send files into the folder.

> **Note**
> A folder you sent to named people shows new files as you add them. A link anyone can open only shows what was there when you made it.

When a link stops working

An expired or revoked file link opens a page headed **Link unavailable**. The line under it says why, such as **This link has expired.**

A folder link that no longer works shows **This link isn't available** instead.



> **Tip**
> If they still need the file, create a new link and send it to them.

PART 2

Going further

14 Meetings and calls

15 Sharing a whole library

16 Groups

17 SharePoint and Windows file shares

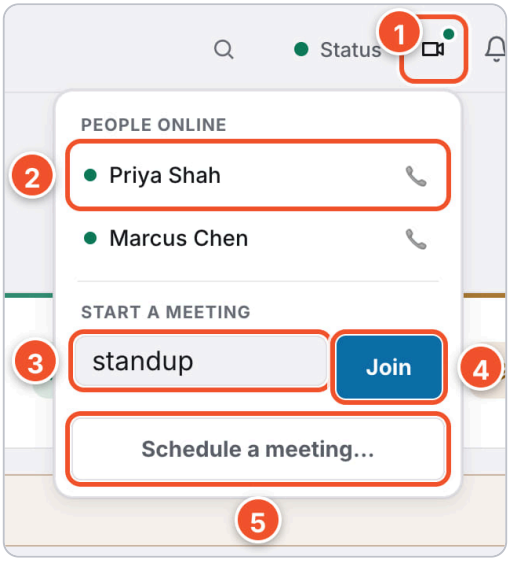
18 Depot on your phone

CHAPTER 14

Meetings and calls

Call a colleague, start a call anyone can join, or schedule one for later. Everything starts from the Meetings icon in the top bar.

See who is online, and start a call



1. Click the Meetings icon. A green dot means someone else is online.
2. Under **People online**, click a name to call that person.
3. Type a room name under **Start a meeting** to start a group call.
4. Click **Join**. Anyone who joins the same room name joins the same call.
5. Click **Schedule a meeting…** to set up a call for later.

Schedule a meeting for later

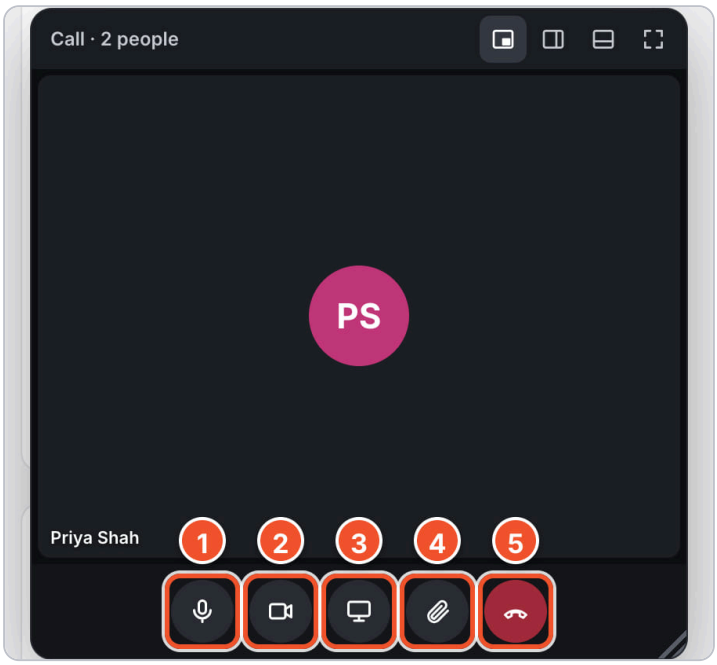
Fill in the **Title**, **Date**, **Time** and **Minutes**. Under **Attendees**, type email addresses separated by commas. Then click **Send invites** to email everyone, or **Copy invite** to copy a join link.

> **Note**
> Everyone who joins needs a Depot account and must sign in.

Answer a call

When someone calls you, Depot shows their name. Click **Accept** to join, or **Decline** if you cannot talk.

In a call



1. Click **Mute** to turn your microphone off or on.
2. Click **Turn camera off** to stop or start your video.
3. Click **Share screen** to show everyone your screen.
4. Click **Send a file** to send a file to everyone on the call.
5. Click **Leave call** when you are finished.

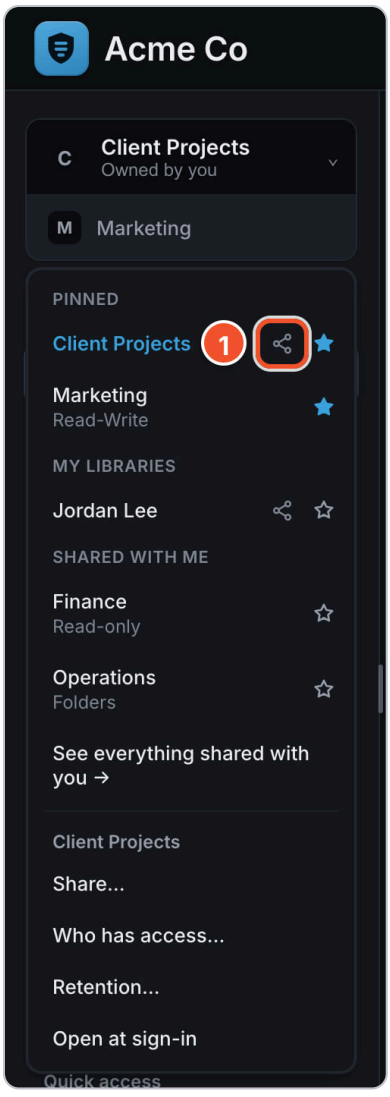
CHAPTER 15

Sharing a whole library

Share a whole library when several people need lasting access to everything in it, including files added later. You can share libraries you own or manage.

Open a library's Share window

Open the library switcher at the top of the left rail.

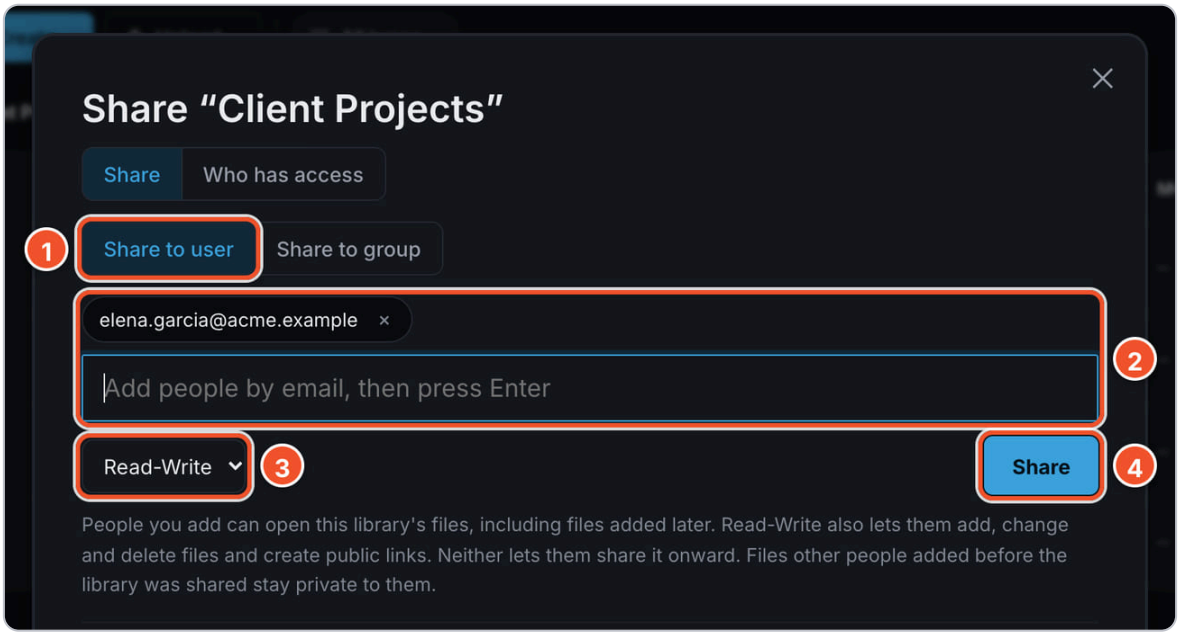


1. Click the **Share** icon next to a library you own.

> **Tip**
>
> For the library you are in, you can also click **Share...** under its name at the bottom of the list.

> **Note**
>
> A library you do not manage shows **Your access...** there instead. It tells you how you can get in, but does not let you change anything.

Share it with a person or a group



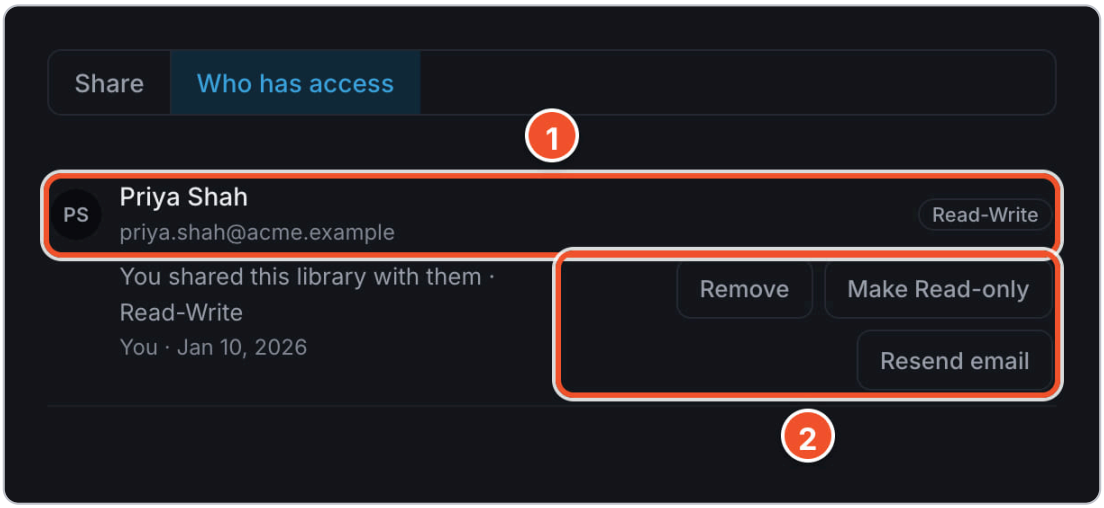
1. Click **Share to user** to add a person, or **Share to group** to add a whole team.
2. Type an email address and press Enter, or choose a group from the list.
3. Choose **Read-Write** or **Read-only**.
4. Click **Share**.

- **Read-Write** lets someone add, change and delete files, and create links to send things to people outside Acme.
- **Read-only** lets someone open and download files, but not change anything.
- To change someone's level, choose a new one from the dropdown next to their name. Click **Remove** to take away their access.

> **Note**
> Neither level lets someone add other people. Only you or your administrator can do that. Files someone added before you shared the library stay private to them.

See everyone who has access

Click **Who has access** at the top of the window. It lists everyone who can open the library, however they got in, including through a group.



1. Click a person's name to see how they can get in.
2. Click **Remove**, **Make Read-only** or **Resend email**.

- Links to files or folders in this library show here too, under **Anyone with a link**, each with its own **Revoke** button.
- People who have not signed in to Depot yet show under **Waiting**. They get in once they sign in with that email address.

Create a library of your own

1. Open the library switcher and click **+ New library** at the bottom of the list.
2. Type a name for the library.
3. Click **Create library**.

> **Note**
> A new library is private until you share it. Only you and your administrator can see it.

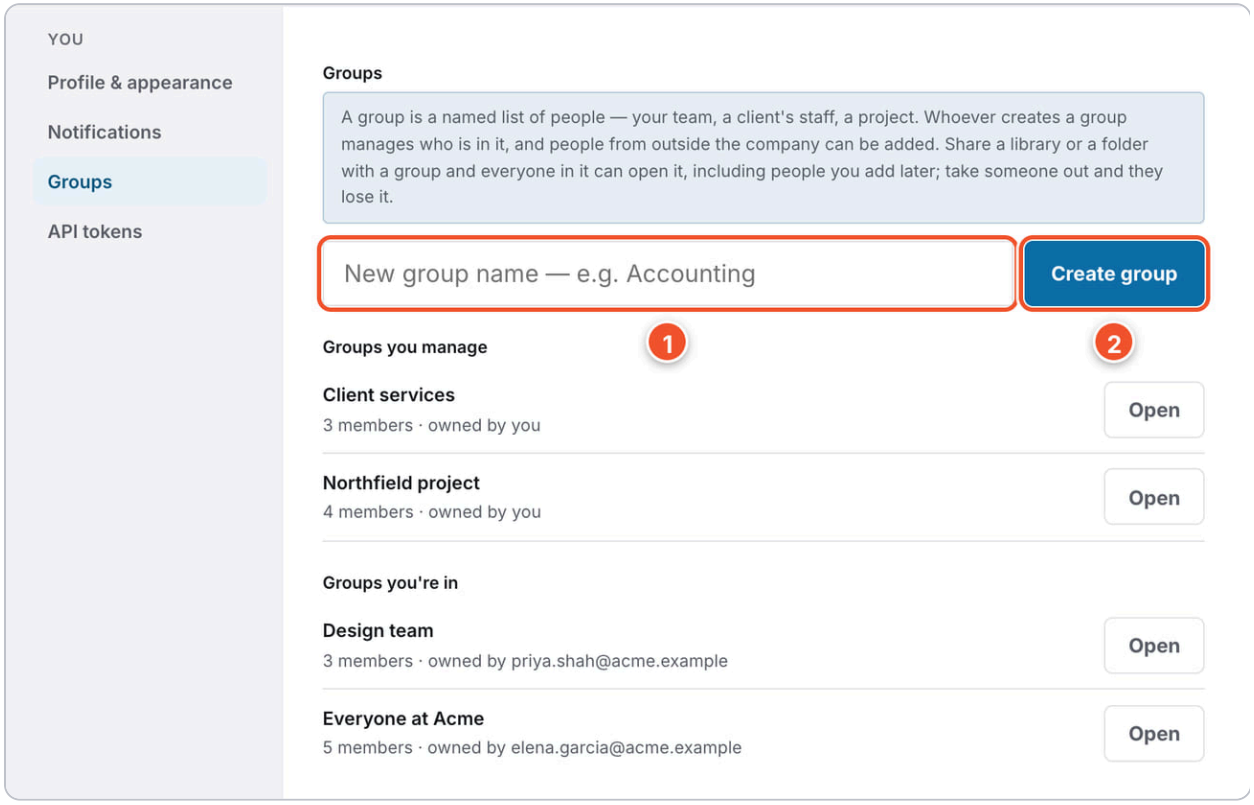
CHAPTER 16

Groups

A group lets you share with a whole team in one step. A group can include people outside Acme.

Create a group

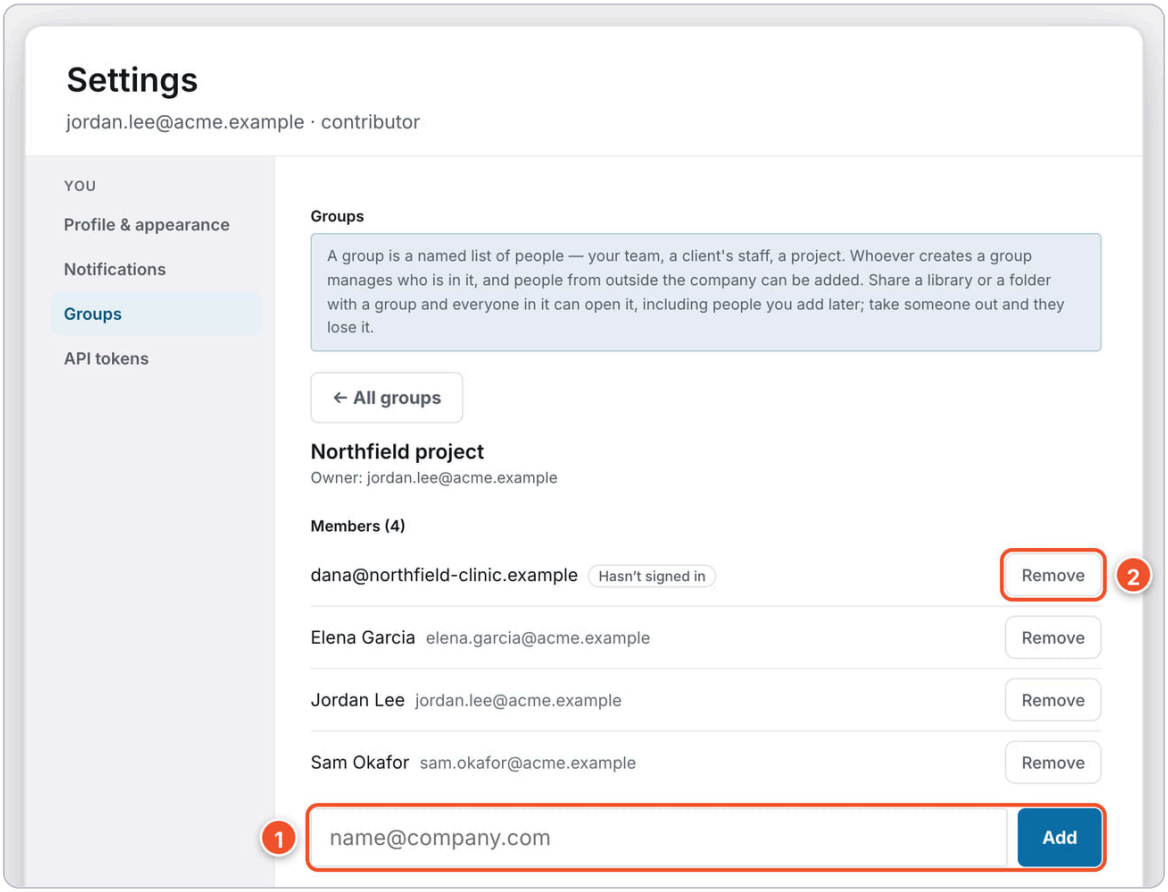
Click the gear in the top bar, then **Groups**.



1. Type a name in the **New group name** box.
2. Click **Create group**.

Add or remove members

Click **Open** next to a group to see who is in it.



1. Type an email address in the box, then click **Add**.
2. Click **Remove** next to someone to take them out. Only the group's owner, or your administrator, can change a group.

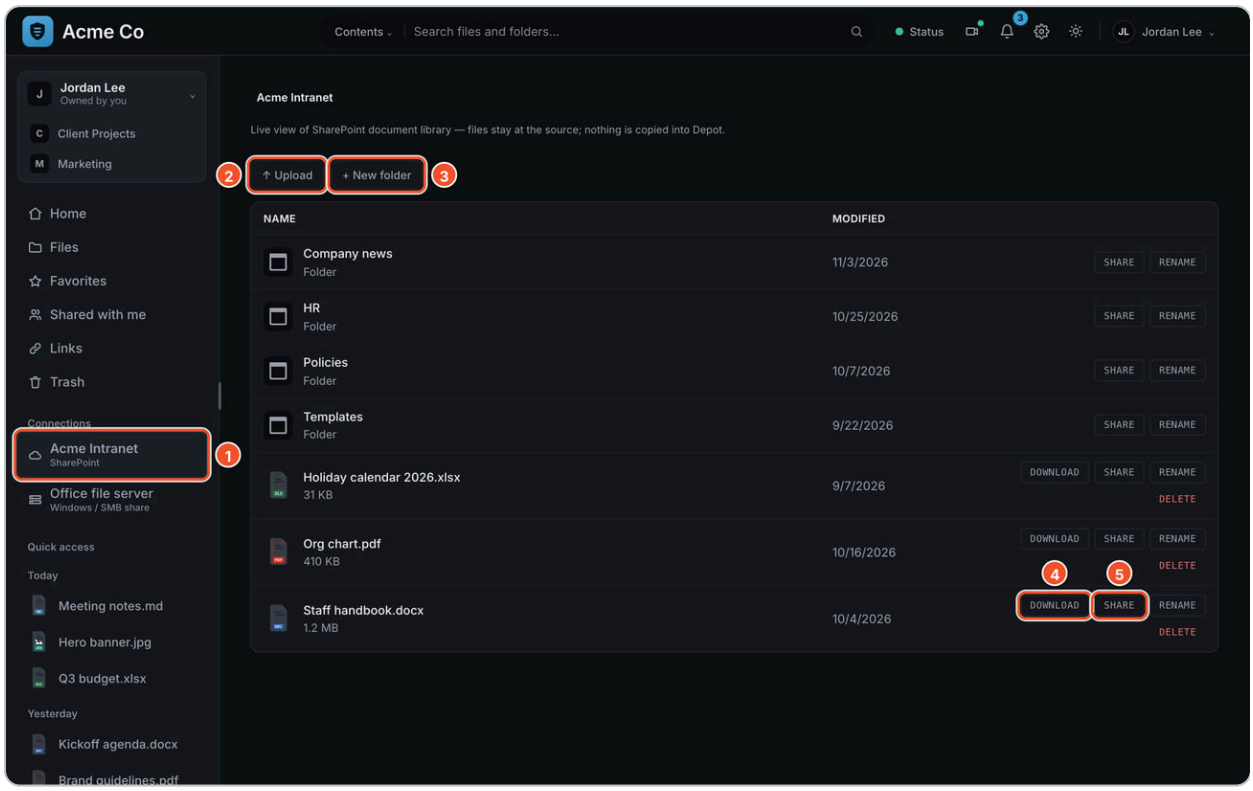
- Choose **Share to group** when you share a library or folder. See “Sharing a whole library”. People you add to the group later get the same access.

CHAPTER 17

SharePoint and Windows file shares

If your company has connected SharePoint or a Windows file share, you can browse it from Depot. Files stay where they are.

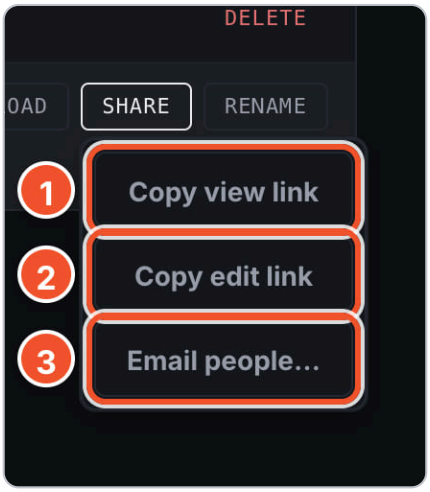
Open a connection



1. Click a name under **Connections**, near the bottom of the left rail.
2. Click **Upload** to add files from your computer.
3. Click **New folder** to add a folder here.
4. Click **Download** on a file's row to save a copy.
5. Click **Share** on a SharePoint file's row to see your sharing options.

- Click **Rename** or **Delete** on a file's row to rename or remove it.
- Click a SharePoint file's name to open it in Microsoft 365.
- Windows file shares have no **Share** button.

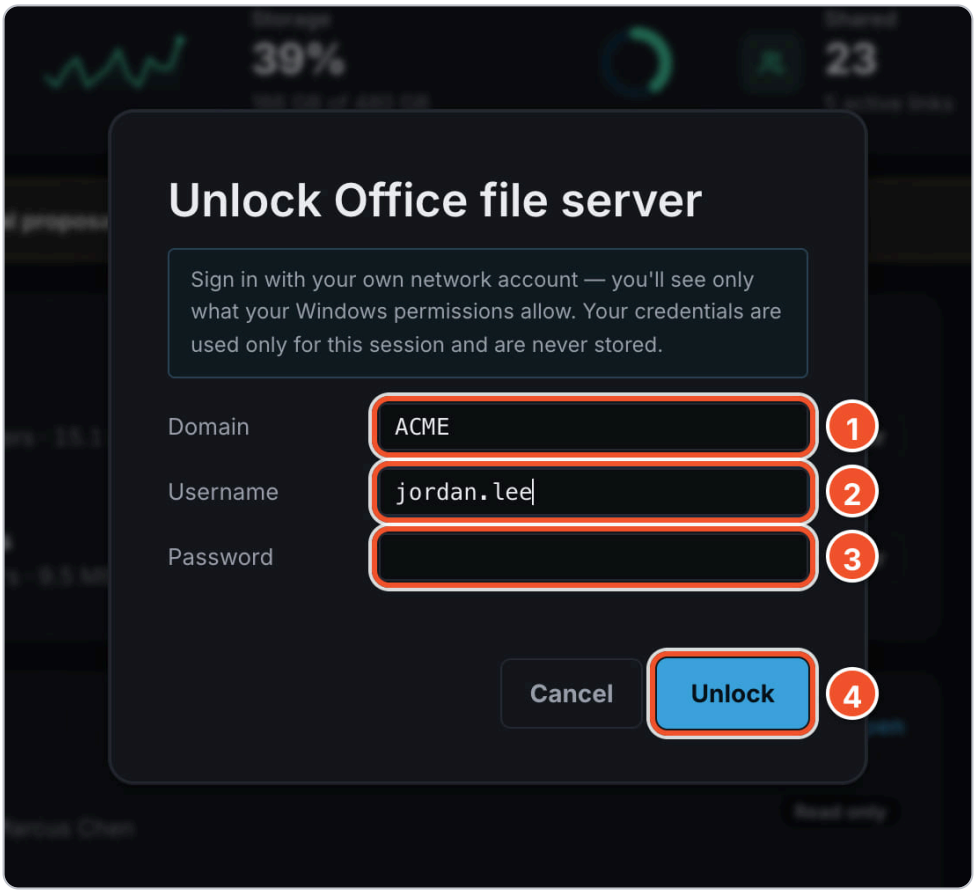
Share a SharePoint file



1. Click **Copy view link** to copy a link anyone can open.
2. Click **Copy edit link** to copy a link people can also change.
3. Click **Email people...** to send it to named people by email.

Unlock a personal Windows share

Some Windows file shares ask for your own network sign-in the first time, so you see only what your account allows.



1. Type your **Domain**.
2. Type your **Username**.
3. Type your **Password**.
4. Click **Unlock**.

> **Note**
> Depot uses your sign-in only for this session, and never saves it. On a shared computer, click **Lock** at the top of the share to make Depot forget it straight away.

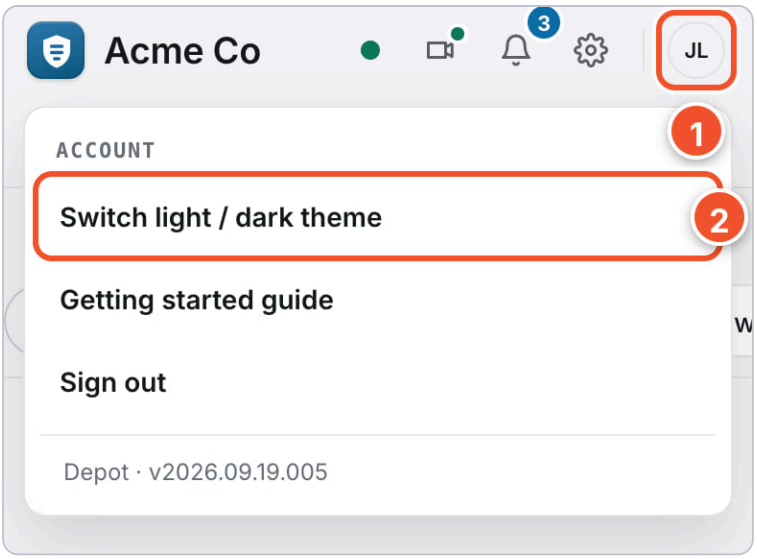
CHAPTER 18

Depot on your phone

Open Depot in your phone's web browser and sign in as usual. The screen rearranges itself to fit.

Home on a phone

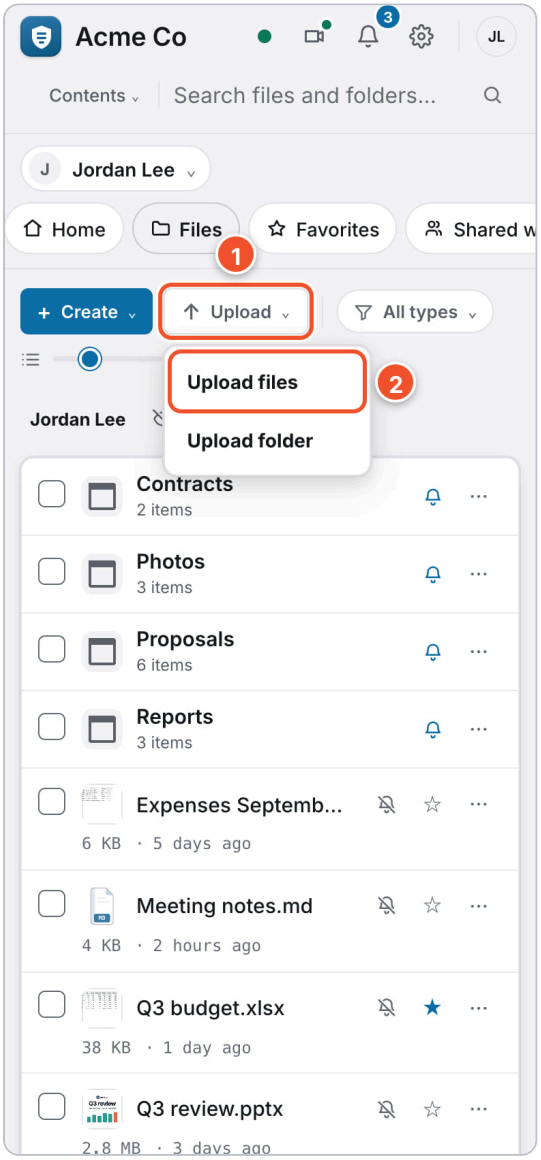
The left rail becomes a row of buttons under the search box. Swipe it sideways to see them all.



1. Tap your initials in the top right corner to open your account menu.
2. Tap **Switch light / dark theme** to change how Depot looks.

Add a photo

Tap **Files** in the row of buttons under the search box to see your files.



1. Tap **Upload**.
2. Tap **Upload files**. Your phone then lets you pick a photo, take a new one, or choose a file.